

Chris De La Garza

Staff Solutions Engineer

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SE of the Year · FY25 | 146.5% Quota Attainment · FY26

Infrastructure Engineer turned Solutions Engineer with a decade of building, breaking, and securing systems across bare metal, cloud, and Kubernetes. Known for building demo and enablement systems that outlast the engagement. Today I'm a Staff Solutions Engineer on Teleport's enterprise team and the SE org's Terraform SME.

[EXPERIENCE]

Teleport

Staff Solutions Engineer

Oct 2026 – Present

Staff Solutions Engineer across Teleport's enterprise segment. I own the technical side of complex engagements.

- Own technical pre-sales for strategic enterprise accounts, including solution design from discovery through close
- Terraform SME for the SE organization: reusable modules, the Teleport Terraform provider, and the IaC patterns the team builds on
- Own the demo framework project used for conference demos, aligning technical and non-technical teams on what we demo
- Mentor SEs and run internal training on Terraform and demo delivery
- Build custom demos for emerging capabilities, including Machine & Workload Identity and Beams

Senior Solutions Engineer

Sep 2023 – Oct 2026

- Enterprise pre-sales across AWS, GCP, Azure, and on-prem; closed the **largest deal in company history** (FY25)
 - Named **Solutions Engineer of the Year FY25**; exceeded quota every year at Teleport, including **146.5% attainment in FY26**
 - Designed and authored the teleport-terraform reference architecture, a full IaC template (EKS control plane, RBAC, SCIM, plugins, database access) adopted as the team's standard demo foundation
 - Rebuilt conference demo infrastructure as documented, repeatable playbooks adopted across the SE org, reducing setup time and improving demo consistency at field events
 - Delivered product demonstrations covering SSH, RDP, Kubernetes, database access, and machine identity across complex customer environments
 - Mentored and supported junior SEs on technical architecture and demo delivery
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Cloudflare

Solutions Engineer – Strategic Accounts

Feb 2022 – Sep 2023

- Supported Central region pre-sales motions, including discovery, solution design, and proofs of concept
 - Technical lead for the Central and West Field/Strategic teams
 - API Shield, Docker, Cloudflare Tunnel, and Terraform SME for North America
 - Developed the syllabus and training materials for new hires, cutting general onboarding from **9 months to 90 days**
 - Created Terraform examples for running Cloudflare at scale
 - Created templates for deploying Cloudflare Tunnel with Terraform, Ansible, Docker, and Docker Compose
 - Assisted with team interviews, structure, and guidance
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NGINX, Inc.

Solutions Engineer III

Jun 2021 – Dec 2021

- Worked directly with NGINX core engineers, product development, and engineering leadership, providing customer feedback on product features and direction, with a focus on financial and public sector clients
 - Assisted with the NGINX Sprint workshop on API management, including administration, testing, and development
 - Designed solutions spanning on-premises bare metal to cloud providers running Kubernetes and microservices environments
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Cloudflare, Inc.

Solutions Engineer

Apr 2019 – May 2021

Technical sales lead for Cloudflare's platform: CDN, DNS, SSL/TLS, WAF, Firewall Rules, Bot Management, Rate Limiting, Image Resizing, Cloudflare for Teams, and Workers. Partnered with sales across pre-sales and post-sales to drive new business and expansion, architecting scalable implementations for enterprise clients.

- Founding member of the Austin Mid-Market SE team; helped create the team's standard operating procedures
 - Technical team lead supporting up to 15 Account Executives and driving cultural initiatives that built team camaraderie
 - Ran enablement sessions for Account Executives and Business Development Reps
 - Interviewed and assisted in hiring SEs, AEs, and Customer Success Managers
 - Helped develop the AE certification for Cloudflare competency
 - Developed reproducible demos with Terraform, shell scripting, and Docker for Cloudflare SEs
 - Led SE booths and built the back-end demo infrastructure for Cloudflare Connect 2019
 - Designed and curated training material for enterprise clients that was adopted throughout Cloudflare
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Rackspace

Linux System Engineer II

Dec 2018 – Apr 2019

- Installed, configured, maintained, and troubleshot customer Linux environments (Apache, MySQL, PHP, FTP, SSH, DNS) on RHEL and Debian
- Supported everything from single LAMP servers to large enterprise environments, including AWS, Azure, and VMware
- Taught customers "how to fish" while advising on technical issues
- Worked with colleagues to automate repetitive work
- Mentored support technicians and provided escalation support for fellow administrators
- Contributed to data center migrations, workload reduction, and account reviews

Linux System Engineer I

Oct 2016 – Nov 2018

- Same scope as Linux System Engineer II; promoted in December 2018.

Global Support Technician II

Apr 2016 – Oct 2016

- Triage work queues and server alerts (disk, file system, URL, port, CPU) for dedicated and cloud customers on Linux and Windows
- Escalation point for troubleshooting and customer issues across chat, phone, and ticket support
- Trained L1 technicians on procedures, queue workflow, and emergency triage, and wrote wiki guides to improve the workflow

Global Support Technician I

Oct 2015 – Apr 2016

- Routed or answered 60+ customer issues a day through queue management and ticket routing
- Diagnosed remote and agent monitoring checks and helped train new L1 technicians

Customer Service Specialist

Mar 2015 – Oct 2015

- Assisted 100–150 customers a day, routing calls to the right support team and walking customers through account security processes
- Trained new team members and maintained the team wiki and calendar

[TECH STACK]

Infrastructure: Terraform / OpenTofu · Ansible · Docker / Docker Compose · Kubernetes (EKS, GKE, AKS) · Cloudflare Tunnels

Cloud & Networking: AWS (EC2, EKS, IAM, VPC, S3) · GCP / Azure · Cloudflare (CDN, WAF, Workers, Zero Trust) · DNS, SSL/TLS, BGP basics

Security & Identity: Teleport (PAM / Zero Trust) · Okta (SAML, SCIM, SSO) · mTLS, PKI, certificate management · RBAC / access request workflows

Databases & Apps: PostgreSQL, MySQL / MariaDB · MongoDB, Cassandra · NGINX, Apache · Python (Flask), Bash

[EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS]

Texas A&M University – Corpus Christi

B.B.A., Bachelor of Business Administration · 2011–2014

Dean's List: Spring 2013, Spring 2014

Certifications

> Great Demo! Practitioner